

5.2.3. Browser Hijackers

These are mostly of nuisance value. Browsers that have been hijacked always open a certain Web page by default on start, or change the home page of the browser, or do not allow certain sites to be visited—usually anti-virus or anti-spyware sites. Trying to uninstall or delete the responsible file proves futile, since some part of the malware is loaded into memory when the system boots.

5.2.4. Spyware

This refers to a class of applications that gains entry into a system and monitors the user without his knowledge. Spyware report back to a remote server and can result in the leaking out of confidential details like usernames and passwords.

5.2.5. Keylogging

This refers to the use of software to record the sequence of keys pressed by the user. Usually, a report of the keystrokes are passed on to the spyware controller on the Internet. Keystrokes of special interest are passwords and usernames, or online banking details.

5.2.6 Viruses

Applications that tag along with other files; running the file causes the virus in it to infect the system.

5.2.7. Trojans

These are applications that gain entry into the user's system by posing as something else, often as free screensavers. After gaining entry into the system and being installed or run by the user, they can manipulate user data. Trojans have different behaviour once they gain access into the system. For example, some allow unauthorised access to a remote user into the user PC by opening up ports, some can act as keyloggers, and some can prevent applications from running—especially anti-virus applications.

5.2.8. Worms

These are applications that autonomously transfer themselves through a network. They do not need an associated file to spread